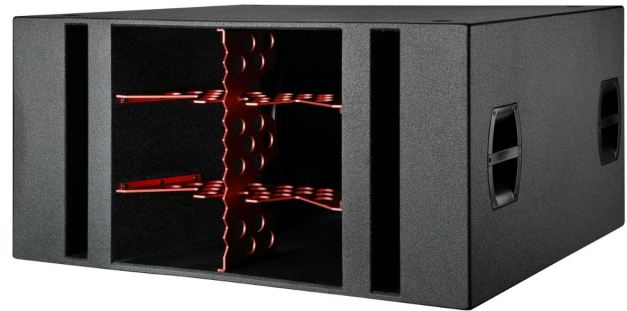


KS-SERIES

USER MANUAL | KS-18 & KS-218



KS-18



KS-218

Single 18" | 1000W RMS | Dual 18" | 2000W RMS

For Touring & Fixed Installations | Night Clubs · Auditoriums · Stadiums · Live Concerts

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1. PRODUCT OVERVIEW

The Louis Martin Audio KS-Series represents the pinnacle of professional passive subwoofer design, engineered to deliver exceptional low-frequency performance for the most demanding live sound and installation environments. Both the KS-18 and KS-218 share a common design philosophy: maximum output, deep extension, and absolute reliability.

Both models feature bandpass ported enclosures crafted from premium birch plywood with polyurea paint finish, providing outstanding rigidity, acoustical integrity, and resilience for touring and fixed installation use.

Key Differences at a Glance

Feature	KS-18	KS-218
Configuration	Single 18" Driver	Dual 18" Drivers
RMS Power	1000W	2000W
Peak Power	4000W	8000W
Sensitivity	98 dB (1W/1m)	102 dB (1W/1m)
Max SPL (Peak)	134 dB	141 dB
Low Freq. Ext.	35 Hz (-10 dB)	30 Hz (-10 dB)
Impedance	8 Ohms	4 Ohms
Weight	58 kg / 127.8 lbs	88 kg / 194.0 lbs

2. KS-18 – Single 18" Passive Subwoofer



KS-18 – Single 18" High-Performance Passive Subwoofer

The KS-18 is a single 18" high-excursion passive subwoofer housed in a bandpass ported enclosure. Engineered to deliver powerful low-frequency reinforcement with exceptional sound quality and reliability, it is powered by a high-performance European driver with a 4" voice coil, ensuring consistent output even under the most demanding operating conditions.

Constructed from premium birch plywood with polyurea paint finish, the KS-18 offers outstanding rigidity, durability, and acoustical integrity — making it ideal for both long-term installations and the rigours of touring use.

Applications

- Night Clubs & Entertainment Venues
- Auditoriums & Concert Halls
- Stadiums & Sport Complexes
- Multifunctional Halls & Conference Centres
- Touring & Live Sound Reinforcement

3. KS-18 – Technical Specifications

SPECIFICATION	VALUE
Type	Passive Subwoofer
Frequency Response (-10 dB)	35 Hz – 120 Hz
Drivers	1 × 18" High-Performance Driver, 4" Voice Coil
Power – RMS	1000 W
Power – Program	2000 W
Power – Peak	4000 W
Sensitivity (1W/1m)	98 dB
Max SPL – Continuous (1m)	131 dB
Max SPL – Peak (1m)	134 dB
Nominal Impedance	8 Ohms
Dispersion	Omnidirectional
Enclosure Type	Bandpass Ported
Cabinet Material	Birch Plywood with Polyurea Paint
Dimensions (H × W × D)	910 mm × 610 mm × 710 mm
Weight	58 kg / 127.8 lbs

4. KS-18 – Dimensional Drawings

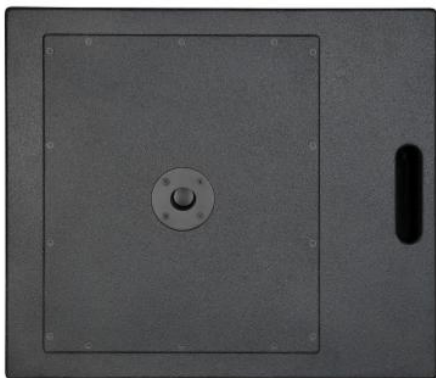
Cabinet Dimensions: 910 mm (H) × 610 mm (W) × 710 mm (D) | Weight: 58 kg / 127.8 lbs



Front View



Rear View



Top View



Bottom View

Dimension	mm	inches (approx.)
Height	910 mm	35.8"
Width	610 mm	24.0"
Depth	710 mm	28.0"
Weight	58 kg	127.8 lbs

5. KS-218 – Dual 18" Passive Subwoofer



KS-218 – Dual 18" High-Performance Passive Subwoofer

The KS-218 is the flagship of the KS-Series, featuring dual 18" high-excursion drivers in a bandpass ported enclosure. Delivering twice the low-frequency output of the KS-18, the KS-218 is purpose-built for large-scale events, stadiums, and installations where maximum SPL and deep bass extension are paramount. With a 4 ohm nominal impedance, it can be efficiently driven by a wide range of professional power amplifiers.

As with the KS-218, the cabinet is constructed from premium birch plywood with a durable polyurea paint finish, and the enclosure is optimised for bandpass loading to maximise efficiency across the full subwoofer bandwidth.

Applications

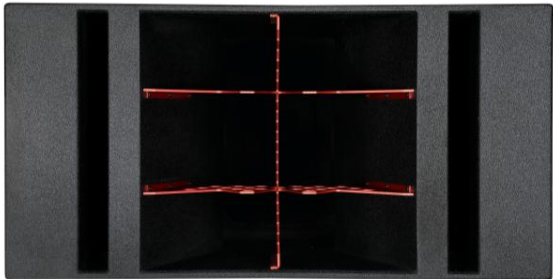
- Night Clubs & Entertainment Venues
- Auditoriums & Concert Halls
- Stadiums & Sport Complexes
- Multifunctional Halls
- Live Concerts & Large-Scale Touring
- Festival & Outdoor Events

6. KS-218 – Technical Specifications

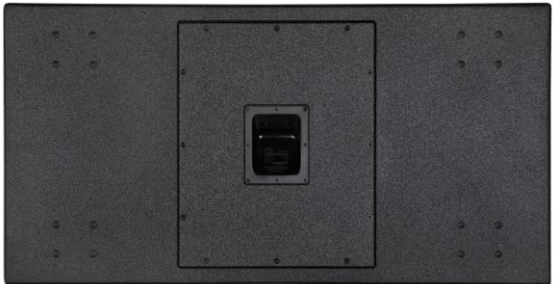
SPECIFICATION	VALUE
Type	Passive Subwoofer
Frequency Response (-10 dB)	30 Hz – 120 Hz
Drivers	2 × 18" High-Performance Drivers, 4" Voice Coil each
Power – RMS	2000 W
Power – Program	4000 W
Power – Peak	8000 W
Sensitivity (1W/1m)	102 dB
Max SPL – Continuous (1m)	138 dB
Max SPL – Peak (1m)	141 dB
Nominal Impedance	4 Ohms
Dispersion	Omnidirectional
Enclosure Type	Bandpass Ported
Cabinet Material	Birch Plywood with Polyurea Paint
Dimensions (H × W × D)	580 mm × 1160 mm × 890 mm
Weight	88 kg / 194.0 lbs

7. KS-218 – Dimensional Drawings

Cabinet Dimensions: 580 mm (H) × 1160 mm (W) × 890 mm (D) | Weight: 88 kg / 194.0 lbs



Front View



Rear View



Side View



Top View

Dimension	mm	inches (approx.)
Height	580 mm	22.8"
Width	1160 mm	45.7"
Depth	890 mm	35.0"
Weight	88 kg	194.0 lbs

8. Installation & Setup Guidelines

Ground Stacking

The KS-18 and KS-218 are suitable for ground stacking in configurations appropriate to the venue size and coverage requirements. Always ensure the floor surface is level and capable of bearing the load of the enclosures and any equipment placed on top. Use non-slip matting under stacked cabinets to prevent movement during operation.

Flying / Rigging

■ **When flying speakers, appropriate certified hardware and techniques must be employed for safely suspending the enclosures. All hardware must comply with local safety regulations.**

All speaker hardware and flying apparatus must be regularly inspected prior to each use for any signs of visual or mechanical failure. Never fly damaged or suspect equipment. Maintain adequate clearance between suspended enclosures and the audience area in accordance with local Health and Safety regulations.

Placement Recommendations

- Position subwoofers as close to the floor boundary as possible to reinforce bass output through boundary loading.
- For stereo sub arrays, consider cardioid subwoofer configurations to reduce rear energy on stage.
- Avoid placing subwoofers near corners in reverberant spaces unless bass build-up is desired.
- Ensure adequate ventilation around enclosures; do not cover or enclose during operation.
- Maintain safe audience distances as required by your local authority.

Environmental Conditions

Protect your speakers and electronics from exposure to humidity, water, or rain at all times. These enclosures are designed for indoor use or covered outdoor environments. Exposure to moisture will void the warranty.

9. System Wiring & Amplifier Pairing

Impedance & Amplifier Selection

Both the KS-18 and KS-218 are passive loudspeakers requiring an external power amplifier. Always match the amplifier's output impedance rating to the cabinet's nominal impedance. Using the Louis Martin digital controller is strongly recommended for optimal performance and system protection.

Model	Impedance	Recommended Amp Power (RMS)	Connector
KS-18	8 Ohms	1000W – 2000W @ 8 Ohms	Speakon
KS-218	4 Ohms	2000W – 4000W @ 4 Ohms	Speakon

Louis Martin Digital Controller

■ The Louis Martin digital controller must only be programmed by an authorised technician. Do not operate KS-Series loudspeakers without the correct controller and programme loaded. Any system failure resulting from incorrect controller use will void the warranty.

The digital controller provides optimised DSP presets including crossover filtering, time alignment, limiting, and equalisation specifically tuned for the KS-18 and KS-218. Always use the appropriate preset for the model in use. Contact your authorised Louis Martin distributor for controller programming and setup support.

Cabling Best Practices

- Use high-quality, appropriately rated speaker cable. Minimum 2.5mm² conductor cross-section recommended for cable runs up to 10m.
- Keep speaker cable runs as short as practicable to minimise resistive losses.
- Never use microphone (balanced) cable for loudspeaker connections — it is not rated for amplifier output current.
- Ensure all connectors are fully seated and locked (Speakon) or securely tightened (binding posts) before powering the system.
- Label all cables clearly with model and channel designation for easy troubleshooting.

10. Safety Instructions

Flying & Rigging

- When flying speakers, appropriate certified hardware and techniques must be employed for safely suspending the enclosures. All flying apparatus must be regularly inspected for any visual or mechanical failure before each use.

Audience Safety

- Leave adequate distance between speakers and the audience. Refer to your local authority for Health and Safety guidance when using loudspeaker systems. Follow all applicable regulations regarding sound pressure levels in public venues.

Controller Use

- The Louis Martin digital controller should only be programmed by an authorised technician. Do not use Louis Martin loudspeaker systems without the correct controller and the programme. If a system fails due to incorrect controller use, the warranty is void.

Water & Humidity

- Protect your speakers and electronics from exposure to humidity, water, or rain at all times. Never operate the equipment in wet conditions or leave it exposed to the elements.

Children & Bystanders

- Keep unauthorised personnel away from speaker stacks and rigging during setup and operation. Ground-stacked subwoofers can be a physical hazard if unsecured.

Hearing Safety

- Prolonged exposure to high sound pressure levels can cause permanent hearing damage. Always use appropriate hearing protection when working in close proximity to operating loudspeaker systems. Comply with local occupational health regulations for noise exposure limits.

Electrical Safety

- Ensure all amplifiers and connected equipment are correctly earthed. Never defeat earth connections in mains-powered equipment. In the event of electrical fault, disconnect power immediately and consult a qualified technician before resuming operation.

11. Warranty Information

Louis Martin Audio stands behind the quality and craftsmanship of every KS-Series loudspeaker. The following warranty terms apply to all KS-Series products purchased from authorised distributors.

Coverage Period

The loudspeakers and electronics are covered against defects in workmanship or materials for a period of TWO (2) YEARS from the original date of purchase.

What Is Covered

- Manufacturing defects in materials or workmanship under normal operating conditions.
- Driver failures not attributable to overpowering, misuse, or incorrect controller settings.
- Cabinet defects under normal use conditions.

What Is NOT Covered

- Damage resulting from user abuse, accident, negligence, or unauthorised modifications.
- Failures caused by operating with incorrect amplifier settings, wrong impedance loads, or without the Louis Martin digital controller.
- Physical damage including broken enclosures, torn drivers, or damaged connectors from mishandling.
- Damage from exposure to moisture, water, extreme temperatures, or adverse environmental conditions.
- Normal wear and tear including cosmetic deterioration of the enclosure finish.

Warranty Claims Procedure

To make a warranty claim, contact your authorised Louis Martin distributor with proof of purchase and a description of the fault. Defective items will be repaired or replaced at no charge for parts or labour, subject to the warranty terms above.

Important: The defective item must be adequately packed and dispatched, freight pre-paid, to an authorised Louis Martin distributor or service centre. Louis Martin Audio accepts no responsibility for items damaged in transit due to inadequate packaging.

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